

Fifth Third Bancorp

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Financial Services
Revenue	\$12.9B
Employees	20,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	82

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Fifth Third Bancorp
Headquarters	Cincinnati, Ohio (legacy Comerica: Dallas, Texas)
Founded	1858
Ownership	Public (NASDAQ: FITB)
Footprint	12 states concentrated in Midwest (Ohio, Michigan, Indiana, Kentucky, Illinois) plus new West Coast and Texas presence from Comerica. ~1,100 branches post-rationalization.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Fifth Third Bancorp is a Cincinnati-based diversified financial services company. Its \$12.3B merger with Comerica made it the 9th largest US bank with ~\$294B in assets, expanding from its Midwest base into Texas and the West Coast through Comerica's Dallas headquarters and California presence.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Fifth Third Bancorp's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue projected to surge 43% from \$9.0B (2025) to \$12.95B (2026) with Comerica contribution. \$850M in annual cost savings targeted. \$294B in combined assets positions Fifth Third as the 9th largest US bank. Analysts bullish on the strategic rationale but flagging execution risk given the speed of closure (under 4 months). EPS accretion expected by 2027. Key risk: system conversion failure or deposit flight during the September transition.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Unknown - Chief Integration Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Unavailable

Outreach rationale: This person owns the Sept 8 system conversion, 63 branch closures, \$850M synergy program, and cultural integration across Midwest/Texas - the highest-stakes organizational execution challenge in US banking.

Unknown - Chief Human Resources Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Unavailable

Outreach rationale: Managing 180+ layoffs, cultural merger between Cincinnati and Dallas workforces, and talent retention

during the most disruptive period.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Tim Spence - Chairman, President and CEO

Former head of Consumer Banking; youngest CEO in Fifth Third's history at appointment

Bryan Preston - Chief Financial Officer

Former Fifth Third Treasurer

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Fifth Third Bancorp operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Traditional bank holding company with functional divisions (Consumer Banking, Commercial Banking, Wealth & Asset Management). Post-merger challenge: integrating Comerica's relationship-heavy commercial banking model (Texas energy, Michigan auto) into Fifth Third's technology-forward retail approach. Comerica's Dallas headquarters becomes a secondary hub, creating dual-city management complexity.

Culture Signals

Fifth Third has invested heavily in fintech partnerships and digital banking, positioning itself as a tech-forward regional bank. Comerica is a traditional relationship bank with deep roots in Texas energy, Michigan automotive, and California middle-market lending. The cultural gap between Cincinnati's midsize-city corporate culture and Dallas's deal-oriented banking culture is significant. The speed of closure (under 4 months) left limited time for cultural due diligence. Employee uncertainty around the 180+ layoffs and 63 branch closures is creating anxiety. [INFERRED: Comerica's Dallas-based employees may resist Cincinnati-centric decision-making]

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Fifth Third Bancorp.

1. 2026-02-02 - Fifth Third completes \$12.3B Comerica acquisition

Merger closed in under 4 months - unusually fast, leaving limited integration planning time

2. 2026-09-08 - Full system conversion scheduled (Comerica -> Fifth Third platform) [UPCOMING]

'Big bang' migration of all Comerica customers to Fifth Third systems - highest-risk moment of the integration

3. 2026-02-02 - 180+ job cuts announced at Comerica's Frisco, Texas facility

First visible integration impact - sets tone for how the merged entity treats legacy Comerica employees

4. 2026-10-01 - 63 overlapping branch closures begin [SCHEDULED]

Physical footprint rationalization - affects customer relationships and community presence

5. 2026-02-16 - Analysts project 43% revenue surge and \$12.95B 2026 revenue

Market expectations are high - integration must deliver quickly

SECTION 6**McChrystal Fit Assessment**

massive active trigger (merger Feb 2026), high-stakes upcoming event (Sept 8 system conversion), clear budget (\$850M synergy program implies advisory capacity), and the dual-city cultural challenge is exactly McChrystal's domain.

Primary Problem

Executing the largest integration in Fifth Third's 168-year history: merging Cincinnati and Dallas banking cultures, executing a Sept 8 system conversion across millions of accounts, closing 63 branches, and capturing \$850M in synergies - all while maintaining customer relationships and regulatory compliance.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Cross-functional alignment and decentralized execution for the system conversion event. The Sept 8 conversion requires coordinating technology, operations, customer communications, branch staff, and regulatory teams across 12 states simultaneously - the exact kind of high-stakes, time-pressured coordination McChrystal designed for.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Fifth Third may view this as a 'banking problem' requiring banking-specific expertise rather than organizational advisory

Integration budget may be tightly controlled with clear cost-savings mandate

CEO Spence may be confident in internal integration capabilities given the fast closure

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey or BCG likely advising on integration strategy and synergy modeling

Accenture or FIS for technology/system conversion

Internal integration team likely well-staffed given the deal size

SECTION 7**Conversation Entry Points**

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. With the Sept 8 system conversion approaching, how are you coordinating across technology, operations,

and branch teams to ensure zero disruption - what's your command-and-control structure for the cutover?

Position McChrystal as having managed exactly these kinds of high-stakes, time-pressured, multi-team coordination events.

2. How is the Cincinnati-Dallas dynamic playing out - are you seeing the expected friction between Comerica's relationship-banking culture and Fifth Third's tech-forward approach?

Cultural integration is often the hidden variable that determines whether synergies materialize.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame around the Sept 8 system conversion as a high-stakes coordination event. McChrystal's experience in high-pressure, multi-team operations (military parallels) maps directly to a 'big bang' system conversion across 12 states.

SECTION 8**Brand Insights & Market Positioning**

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Fifth Third Bancorp's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Fifth Third has invested in modernizing its brand with digital-first positioning and fintech partnerships (e.g., Provide for healthcare professionals). Comerica's brand is associated with traditional relationship banking in Texas energy and Michigan automotive sectors. The brand challenge: maintaining Fifth Third's tech-forward positioning while absorbing Comerica's relationship-heavy client base. Brand consolidation across 12 states requires unified messaging that doesn't alienate either legacy customer base. [INFERRED: the speed of the merger may have outpaced brand integration planning]

SECTION 9**Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis**

This is the strategic case for pursuing Fifth Third Bancorp. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions**Fit Dimension 1: September 8 System Conversion**

The 'big bang' migration of all Comerica customer accounts to Fifth Third's platform is the single highest-risk moment in the integration. It requires simultaneous coordination across IT, operations, customer service, branch operations, and regulatory teams across 12 states. McKinsey can design the project plan; McChrystal builds the cross-functional command structure that prevents failure on game day.

Fit Dimension 2: Dual-City Cultural Integration

Cincinnati HQ must integrate Dallas operations without creating a colonial dynamic. Comerica's 180-year Texas heritage can't be dismissed. McChrystal's shared consciousness model enables distributed authority - Dallas

retains operational autonomy within Fifth Third's strategic framework.

Fit Dimension 3: Synergy Execution Under Time Pressure

\$850M in annual cost savings with branch closures beginning late 2026. The speed of merger closure (under 4 months) compressed integration planning time. McChrystal's rapid execution framework (built for time-pressured military operations) translates directly to compressed integration timelines.

9b. Cumulative Case

Signal chain: \$12.3B merger (Feb 2026) -> 43% revenue surge -> 180+ layoffs -> 63 branch closures -> Sept 8 system conversion -> \$850M synergy target. Every signal is actively in play right now. The Sept 8 deadline creates urgency that can't be deferred.

Revenue potential: \$750K system conversion coordination (3-4 months), \$1.5M full integration operating model (6-12 months), \$500K/year ongoing advisory.

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Big Bang System Conversion Risk: Sept 8 migration is an all-or-nothing event. Any failure cascades into customer attrition, regulatory scrutiny, and market confidence loss.
2. Dual-City Power Dynamics: Cincinnati vs. Dallas creates a headquarters-vs-satellite tension that permeates every integration decision.
3. Speed-vs-Quality Tradeoff: Under-4-month closure compressed planning; integration teams are building while running.
4. Branch Closure Community Impact: 63 closures affect community relationships and employee morale in overlap markets.
5. Commercial Banking Culture Clash: Comerica's energy/auto relationship banking vs. Fifth Third's diversified, tech-forward approach creates client management friction.
6. Talent Retention in Competitive Markets: Dallas and California banking markets offer Comerica employees abundant alternatives if integration feels hostile.

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. System Conversion Command Structure - Design and implement cross-functional coordination for Sept 8 cutover. Measurable: zero-disruption conversion with <0.5% customer attrition within 30 days.
2. Dual-City Operating Model - Framework for Cincinnati-Dallas authority distribution. Measurable: decision-making speed parity between cities within 6 months.
3. Synergy Capture Acceleration - Cross-functional teams for \$850M program. Measurable: 50% of target achieved within first 12 months.
4. Cultural Integration Program - Bridge building between banking cultures. Measurable: employee engagement scores above 70% in legacy Comerica markets within 12 months.
5. Branch Closure Execution Framework - Coordinated closure program that preserves customer relationships.

Measurable: >90% customer retention in closing markets.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

Consumer Banking

Leader: Unknown

Function: Retail, Digital

McChrystal Relevance: Primary customer impact surface for system conversion

Commercial Banking

Leader: Unknown

Function: C&I, Energy, Auto lending

McChrystal Relevance: Cultural integration between Comerica and Fifth Third approaches

Wealth & Asset Management

Leader: Unknown

Function: Private banking, Trust

McChrystal Relevance: High-value client retention during transition

Technology & Operations

Leader: Unknown

Function: IT, System conversion

McChrystal Relevance: Sept 8 cutover owner

Texas/West Coast Region (legacy Comerica)

Leader: Unknown

Function: Regional banking

McChrystal Relevance: Highest cultural friction zone

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: The Sept 8 system conversion is a fixed deadline. Integration coordination must be in place months before. McChrystal's value is highest in the pre-conversion coordination buildup (April-August 2026). Waiting past Q2 makes it too late.

Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey designs integration plans and models synergies. The Sept 8 conversion is an execution event - it requires the kind of multi-team, time-pressured coordination that McChrystal built its methodology around. This is operational, not strategic.

Phased Engagement:

- Phase 1 (\$500K-\$750K, 3-4 months): System conversion coordination framework + cultural integration diagnostic. Beachhead: the conversion command structure - every other integration workstream connects to this.
- Phase 2 (\$1M-\$1.5M, 6-12 months): Full integration operating model across all business lines.
- Phase 3 (\$400K-\$500K/year): Ongoing advisory through synergy program.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit:

- Thread 1: Chief Integration Officer - direct approach on conversion coordination
- Thread 2: CHRO - cultural integration expertise
- Thread 3: CEO Spence - McChrystal network banking CEO connections